CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 14

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- The lighter colour looks less professional.
- The darker coloured one fits you better.
- You really should get both, not just one.
- Pick either one, both are good choices.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- the lighter one
- the darker one
- the one that costs more
- the one that fits better

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to ask for a refund
- to get store credit
- to buy an extra shirt
- to exchange a shirt

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- Refunds never, exchanges within a month.
- This month all sales are considered final.
- Refunds are given only within two weeks.
- Exchange or store credit within two weeks.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He allowed only an item exchange.
- He offered store credit for a return.
- He recommended a partial refund.
- He suggested a higher value item.

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- a new scarf
- a new belt
- some socks
- some earrings

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She got two new items of clothing.
- She traded a shirt for a costlier one.
- She really needed a pair of socks.
- She received a bit of money back.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Their children play sports together.
- ◯ They work at the same location.
- ◯ They are married to each other.
- ◯ They share carpool duties.

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ rewarding
- ◯ relaxing
- ◯ boring
- ◯ tiring

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Outdoor activities have advantages.
- ◯ Soccer is unpleasant in bad weather.
- ◯ Children's hockey is boring to watch.
- ◯ Kids should keep their rooms tidy.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It should be considered real work.
- ◯ Hard work can be enjoyable.
- ◯ She has too much work to do.
- ◯ Work is easier than family life.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ regrets
- ◯ warnings
- ◯ complaints
- ◯ preferences

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ details about workplace massages
- ◯ gift certificates for massages
- ◯ her opinion on massage for relaxation
- ◯ details about better workplace chairs

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ He went to her business.
- ◯ He telephoned her.
- ◯ He invited her to his office.
- ◯ His co-worker introduced them.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ for a special office event
- ◯ as a regular on-site health option
- ◯ to improve company success
- ◯ as treatment for workplace injuries

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ remain dressed and sit in a special chair
- ◯ remove most clothes and be oiled
- ◯ recline in a special chair and listen to music
- ◯ remove jacket, tie, and shirt or top

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He wants to save the company money.
- ◯ He's worried about the total cost.
- ◯ Massage is usually a medical service.
- ◯ The company staff likely have health plans.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ happy workers
- ◯ stress-free workers
- ◯ fewer sick days for workers
- ◯ healthier lifestyle for workers

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Sarah placed her ring _____
- ◯ on the store counter.
- ◯ in her clothing.
- ◯ in her art kit.
- ◯ in her friend's college bag.

2. Sarah lost her ring when she was _____
- ◯ getting dressed.
- ◯ taking clothes to a store.
- ◯ moving some boxes.
- ◯ taking an art class.

3. When Sarah realized her mistake, she _____
- ◯ was hopeful the ring would be found.
- ◯ thought the store clerk stole it.
- ◯ was pessimistic about getting it back.
- ◯ thought her friend had kept it.

4. Sarah got her ring back because _____
- ◯ the store clerk found it and returned it.
- ◯ a girl found it and returned it to the store.
- ◯ a girl found it in her college bag.
- ◯ she offered a five thousand dollar reward.

5. Sarah arranged for _____
- ◯ her ring to be kept in a safer place.
- ◯ the girl to take art classes.
- ◯ the ring to be taken out of the box.
- ◯ the girl to go to a popular rock concert.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. In what order are the travel options discussed?
- ◯ bus, train, van
- ◯ bus, van, train
- ◯ train, bus, van
- ◯ train, van, bus

2. What is true of group discounts on train tickets?
- ◯ Everyone must get on and off at the same stop.
- ◯ Group discounts are not offered on weekends.
- ◯ Six passengers must all buy tickets together.
- ◯ Seniors' and group rates cannot be combined.

3. What is the advantage of rail travel?
- ◯ the convenient departure station
- ◯ the two-way individual ticket price
- ◯ the predictably short trip duration
- ◯ the station where everyone gets off

4. Where do most of the club members probably live?
- ◯ in the downtown area
- ◯ near a subway line
- ◯ in suburban areas
- ◯ near a bus station

5. Can club members get on the train near their homes?
- ◯ No, they must all board at the central station.
- ◯ Maybe, and one of the men will find out.
- ◯ Probably, but only if they get on together.
- ◯ Yes, but it means no group discount.

6. What does the man in the middle want to maximize?
- ◯ the amount of sightseeing on the way
- ◯ the length of time spent in Montreal
- ◯ the number of club members aged 55+
- ◯ the seating capacity of the charter bus

PART 5

7. Overall, what is the group's main priority?

- ◯ ability to stop along the way
- ◯ convenient departure point
- ◯ per passenger travel costs
- ◯ total round trip transit time

8. If nine members sign up, how will they probably travel?

- ◯ charter tour bus
- ◯ passenger van
- ◯ railway train
- ◯ small aircraft

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Urban chicken supporters initially wanted _____

- ◯ to offer an eco-friendly means of egg farming.
- ◯ to raise awareness of animal rights issues.
- ◯ to help the earth by growing their own food.
- ◯ to contribute to the city food bank for the poor.

2. For Chang, the problem with the "grow your own food" movement is that _____

- ◯ the hungry and poor need food for a lifetime, not just two years.
- ◯ backyard food production ultimately harms humans and wildlife.
- ◯ growing your own food doesn't mean raising your own chickens.
- ◯ those too poor to purchase food are also too poor to produce it.

3. Webster advocates urban farming because he believes _____

- ◯ people can learn valuable farming practices.
- ◯ it is a person's right to be able to produce food.
- ◯ animals are treated better than on factory farms.
- ◯ it can boost a community's supply of food.

4. All three people agree that urban chickens _____

- ◯ do not live long enough.
- ◯ are often abandoned.
- ◯ spread bird diseases.
- ◯ attract wild predators.

5. If the bylaw is revoked, there will be a decrease in _____

- ◯ city chicken euthanization.
- ◯ local coyote sightings.
- ◯ animal cruelty incidents.
- ◯ food bank dependence.

6. Jones would like to see the bylaw _____

- ◯ removed entirely.
- ◯ left as it is.
- ◯ tightened up.
- ◯ passed immediately.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	
Question 2	Pick either one, both are good choices.
Question 3	the lighter one
Question 4	to exchange a shirt
Question 5	Exchange or store credit within two weeks.
Question 6	He offered store credit for a return.
Question 7	some socks
Question 8	She got two new items of clothing.

PART 2	
Question 1	They work at the same location.
Question 2	tiring
Question 3	Outdoor activities have advantages.
Question 4	Work is easier than family life.
Question 5	complaints

PART 3	
Question 1	details about workplace massages
Question 2	He went to her business.
Question 3	for a special office event
Question 4	remain dressed and sit in a special chair
Question 5	The company staff likely have health plans.
Question 6	happy workers

PART 4	
Question 1	in her clothing.
Question 2	taking clothes to a store.
Question 3	was pessimistic about getting it back.
Question 4	a girl found it and returned it to the store.
Question 5	the girl to go to a popular rock concert.

PART 5	
Question 1	train, van, bus
Question 2	Everyone must get on and off at the same stop.
Question 3	the predictably short trip duration
Question 4	in suburban areas
Question 5	Maybe, and one of the men will find out.
Question 6	the length of time spent in Montreal
Question 7	per passenger travel costs
Question 8	passenger van

PART 6	
Question 1	to offer an eco-friendly means of egg farming.
Question 2	those too poor to purchase food are also too poor to produce it.
Question 3	it can boost a community's supply of food.
Question 4	are often abandoned.
Question 5	city chicken euthanization.
Question 6	tightened up.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman in a clothing store. The man is a salesperson, and the woman is a shopper.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Can I ask your opinion? Both these shirts fit me . . . but which one suits me better?

MAN: I think they'd both look great on you.

WOMAN: Mmmm. But I'm going to buy only one of them. I can't decide. On this one, the neckline really suits my height, and the light colour goes well with my hair. But this other one's darker and more formal, which I like, too.

MAN: Hmm. Where will you be wearing the shirt?

WOMAN: The office. I've been promoted and I'll need some clothes for meetings with clients.

MAN: Then maybe . . . dress to fit the situation and go with the more formal one?

WOMAN: Yes . . . but I want to make an impression. I need something that looks really good on me.

MAN: Hmm. Tough decision. They're both good picks.

WOMAN: I think I'll take the lighter one. I like it better. I like the price better, too.

MAN: I'll ring it up for you.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. What did the shopper buy?
2. What best sums up the salesperson's advice?
3. Which style did the shopper choose?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Excuse me, I bought this shirt here recently, but I'm bringing it back. Here's the receipt.

MAN: Thanks . . . [pause] I'm sorry, this receipt is from last month. You bought the shirt almost two weeks ago. I'm afraid we give refunds only within one week of the date of purchase. But we could still give you store credit.

WOMAN: No, actually, all I want is to swap this shirt for one I like better.

MAN: Oh! You want to exchange it. In that case, by all means. You can exchange the shirt for an item of equal or lesser value.

WOMAN: Well that works out well. I know exactly which one I'm after. I think it was a bit more expensive, though.

MAN: Which shirt was it? Was it over here?

WOMAN: That dark one over there. Size 32, please.

Now answer questions 4-6.

4. Why did the shopper come back?
5. What is one of the store's policies on returned items?
6. What did the salesperson do?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Here you go. Oh, look, this shirt's on sale. Now it costs less than the one you're bringing back!

WOMAN: Really?! That's a good deal.

MAN: But remember, it's an exchange, so I can't give you any money back. You may as well pick up something else, too. How about a belt?

WOMAN: Uh, let me think . . . I really don't need anything else.

MAN: Earrings, perhaps? Or a scarf?

WOMAN: I think I'll just get . . . these socks here. You can never have too many socks.

MAN: All right then. With the socks, the difference is $3.45. How would you like to pay?

WOMAN: By cash: toonies and quarters.

Now answer questions 7-8.

7. What did the shopper buy?
8. Which statement is true of the shopper?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation about a very busy weekend.

MAN: Good morning, Sue. How was your weekend?

WOMAN: Ugh, it's all a blur. It started on Friday night with my younger son's baseball award ceremony. It was nice to see him get his trophy, but I have to confess it was tough sitting through 3 hours of trophy presentations.

MAN: I'll bet. Did you get to relax a bit after that?

WOMAN: Saturday morning, I was up at 6:00 a.m. to take my other son and his friends to hockey practice. It was my weekend for carpool duty. Hockey's not really my thing, you know, but we have to show our support for the kids.

MAN: Well, at least the arena's indoors. My wife and I used to freeze to death on the soccer field watching our kids' matches in the rain or snow. How was the rest of your weekend?

WOMAN: We spent what was left of Saturday getting ready for my daughter's birthday party—baking the cake, preparing the games, stuffing the pinata, filling up loot bags, blowing up a zillion balloons, decorating the living room... So Sunday was utter chaos. It took 3 hours to have the party... and 6 hours to clean up the mess!

MAN: When my kids were little, I always felt lucky they were born in summer. Their birthday parties were always outdoors—the park, the carnival, the beach, the go-cart track, the campground... That way, the kids never wrecked my house.

WOMAN: Lucky you! My kids' birthdays are in January and February. Maybe next year instead of letting them wreck my house, I should send them outside to play in the snow.

MAN: Or the ice arena... Maybe you should learn to play hockey with them. Anyway, here you are back at the sweat shop to do some "real" work, eh?

WOMAN: Trust me, coming here feels like play compared to what I do at home.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. How are the speakers related?
2. How was the woman's weekend?
3. What do the woman and the man agree on?
4. What does the woman say about her job?
5. Overall, what is the woman expressing?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation about a massage service for office workers.

WOMAN: Hi there! Welcome to Wellness Massage and Spa. How are you today?

MAN: Very well, thank you. I'm organizing a corporate event for my company and my boss has requested something a little different this time. A co-worker said she gets massages here, and she recalled that you offer on-site workplace massage therapy. Is that right?

WOMAN: Absolutely! You've come to the right place. We specialize in providing mobile effective stress relief and therapeutic chair massages. Studies of ongoing office massage programs have shown that regular massage sessions result in better performance and decreased job stress and anxiety.

MAN: Sounds like what every workplace needs! I've always thought that massage would be a good component of a company's success strategy. It's good to keep workers happy. Is it like a normal spa massage?

WOMAN: No, it's quite different. Our practitioners come to your workplace with portable ergonomic massage chairs. You stay fully dressed, but of course you can remove your suit jacket and tie to be more comfortable. We never use oils. We do, however, bring music to set a soothing atmosphere for relieving tension.

MAN: What's an ergonomic chair?

WOMAN: It's designed so that the client's chest and head rest on support cushions, which reduces pressure on the hips and spinal column. One of the biggest complaints of office workers is tension in the neck and shoulders. Our practitioners work on these areas to relieve stress symptoms.

MAN: Great. Now, I should inquire, is office chair massage covered by an extended health care plan, and are your practitioners fully insured?

WOMAN: Yes, our practitioners are fully certified and insured. However, unless your health care plan includes individual discretionary funds, which usually cover things such as fitness memberships, it won't be covered by your plan. We are certified massage practitioners, but not massage therapists. We focus on relaxation and stress reduction, rather than treatment of specific injuries.

MAN: I see. Well, that's not a problem. I'd like to book your company. Anything else I need to know?

WOMAN: Wonderful! Fees and prices are listed in our booklet right here. There's quite a range of options, depending on how many practitioners you would like to hire. Let me show you.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What does the man want from the woman?
2. How did the man meet the woman?
3. How will the man's company use the massage services?
4. What will workers need to do for the massage?
5. Why does the man ask about health plan coverage?
6. What does the man expect to result from massage services?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a lost ring.

Sarah Hunter is smiling again, now that her engagement ring is back on her finger where it belongs. Last Saturday, Sarah was attending an art class when she decided to remove her engagement ring and put it in her jacket pocket. After her class, she took a box of old clothing, including the jacket, to be sold in the local second-hand store. Later that day, Sarah suddenly realized her mistake. She immediately called the thrift store only to discover that her jacket had just been sold. "I honestly never expected to see my engagement ring again," said Sarah. Surprisingly, the young girl who purchased the jacket soon discovered the ring and promptly brought it back to the thrift store. Sarah was astonished and thrilled at the return of the ring, which is valued at five thousand dollars. Sarah immediately contacted the young girl, a music student at Fairmont College, and thanked her for being so honest. The young girl quietly explained, "I knew that I'd feel devastated if something like this had happened to me, so I had to return it." Fortunately for the young girl, Sarah's fiancé performs in a popular rock group and has given her front row tickets to his sold out concert scheduled for next month.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion between three people who belong to a singles' social club. They are planning a group trip to Montreal.

WOMAN: So, as of today we have six members signed up for our Montreal trip. I'm still waiting to hear back from four others. Everyone wants to keep round-trip travel costs to $100 a person.

MAN 1: The cheapest weekend train fare you can get this time of year is $300 a person, round trip. And that's the seniors' rate for ages 55 and up! Only some of us fall into that age group.

MAN 2: Well, $300 is a lot more than I intended to pay. Is that a group rate?

MAN 1: No, that's the individual rate for up to six seniors . . . We only have six people signed up so far. If ten or more people sign up, we qualify for the group rate.

WOMAN: Now, the problem with the train is that it leaves from Central Station. And with all the downtown traffic congestion, it can be hard for people to get to, especially if they're not one of the few urban dwellers among us . . . or unless they live near public transit. Is it possible that we can catch the train somewhere near our homes?

MAN 1: I'll have to get back to you on that. I do know that in order to qualify for the group discount, we'd all have to board and disembark at the same station!

WOMAN: Hmm. That's not so great. Would we be able to rent a van? That way, we can pick up and drop off people right at their doorsteps.

MAN 2: Well, for seven to fifteen people, we could rent a passenger van. You wouldn't have to pay me to drive it. But I would have to get back to you with a quote about the rental cost. But if we had, say, sixteen to twenty-four people, we could charter a small tour bus and hire a driver.

MAN 1: But wouldn't a bus take longer than the train? We've only got a three-day weekend!

MAN 2: Well, a nonstop train gets you there in five hours; we know this for sure. The bus would only take longer if we decided to take breaks along the way. But sightseeing breaks are a bonus. We all agreed on that. I mean, that's one reason we chose not to go by air in the first place.

MAN 1: One of the downside of chartering a bus is it would cost thousands of dollars, and we'd have to pay the driver. We'd have to fill every seat to make it cost effective.

WOMAN: Okay, so . . . highway or railway? In terms of price, it sounds to me like six of one, half a dozen of the other. It really depends on how many people we can get. Once we know that, we can firm up pricing.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a report about urban chicken bylaws.

Sarah Chang, manager of the Vancouver Animal Shelter, says it's time for the feathers to fly at City Hall over the issue of backyard chicken farming. Chang is petitioning the city to revoke a two-year-old bylaw allowing city residents to raise poultry. The law was initially brought before city council by ecologically-minded Vancouverites ultimately seeking to help the environment by producing a homegrown alternative to factory-farmed eggs. While most residents supported the initiative, critics were concerned about the potential for excessive noise, predatory wildlife, poor sanitation, and even bird flu. But Chang's primary concern was the birds themselves. She feared backyard poultry farming would cause an influx of abandoned chickens on animal shelter doorsteps—a prediction which she confirms has come to pass.

But Bruce Webster, an activist and poultry expert who spent 5 years battling city council to allow urban chickens, has no intention of seeing the bylaw overturned and his own pair of hens exiled from the city. While Webster admits the city has seen some predatory coyotes and abandoned hens, he stresses larger food issues. Ensuring access to food is a major concern throughout the world, and even Canada is not invulnerable to hunger and food supply problems. Webster points to the growing need for food banks in urban centres. One solution, says Webster, is local food production, and backyard chicken coops are a part of it.

Also a supporter of local food production, Chang argues that it shouldn't come at the cost of animal welfare. Many well-intentioned city dwellers start raising chickens, only to discover they're far more work than expected. Most chickens lay eggs for just two of their ten year lifespan, which, for many urbanites, amounts to too much work for too little payoff. The result, says Chang, is that hundreds of chickens end their lives in crowded, underfunded animal shelters. Many are euthanized. Chang also questions whether urban chicken farming actually aids those in genuine need of access to affordable food. After all, raising fowl generally requires a backyard. Vancouverites lucky enough to have one tend to be upper middle class homeowners who could afford to buy—and don't really need to raise—organic free-range poultry products.

So, should the urban chicken bylaw be revoked? City councillor Rita Jones thinks the bylaw just needs more teeth. In addition to the existing limit of 4 hens and the ban on noisy roosters, Jones wants routine government inspections, fines for abandonment, and a requirement that wannabes first receive training. Educating prospective chicken owners about what's involved, says Jones, would weed out negligent ones before their livestock meet the same demise as the city's unwanted pets.